

MINIMUM SPECS YOU SHOULD LOOK FOR AT DIFFERENT PRICE POINTS

	5k to 10k	10k to 15k	15k to 20k	20k to 30k	30k to 40k	40k above
Processor (64-bit architecture must)	1.2 GHz quad-core and above	1.5GHz quad-core and above	1.5GHz quad-core and above	1.5GHz, quad-core	1.8GHz quad-core min.	2.2Ghz and above, octa-core minimum
RAM	1GB or more	2GB or more	2GB or more	2GB and above	3GB and above	3-4GB
Screen	720p	FHD if above 5 inch, HD is 5inch or below	FHD if above 5 inch, HD is 5inch or below	FHD	FHD or above	QHD
Design	Plastic, any kind	Matte plastic	Matte plastic	Metal/Glass	Metal/Glass	Metal+Water Resistant
Camera	8MP and more	13MP and more	13MP and more	16MP and above	16MP and above	16MP and above
Battery	2000 mAh minimum	2600 mAh and above	2600 mAh and above	3000 mAh and above	3000 mAh and above	3000 mAh and above
Connectivity	4G	4G, USB OTG	4G, USB OTG	4G, USB OTG	4G, USB OTG	4G, USB OTG
Storage	16GB min	16GB+SD Card or more	32GB and above	32GB and above	32GB and above	32GB and above
Operating System	Last but one	Newest	Newest	Newest	Newest	Newest possible

price you're paying (see table). While battery capacity isn't directly proportional to battery life, it is a good indicator of what you can expect.

You can also consider things like water resistance and the material used to make the smartphone. While metal bodies are considered to be the best, they don't explicitly mean quality. Apple's iPhones and some HTC phones really premium metal designs, while there are other metallic phones in the market that aren't really up to the same level. The design aspect depends on looks, usability and sturdiness. While looks are subjective to the user, usability and sturdiness are something only reviews can tell you. Look for keywords such as 'curved back', 'thin bezel' etc. Glass is also a very premium material to look at, but you must consider the fact that it can break easily.

WITH THAT SAID...

The interesting part about the results here is that no phone really came out of this test

with a rating that was higher than its original score. What it does show is how much the overall buying decision can change.

For example, the Samsung Galaxy S6, which was earlier rated at 85 dropped to 76, while the iPhone 6, which was originally rated at 84, dropped to only 81 despite the new parameters. The LG G4, on the other hand, dropped from the original rating of 74 to 69. This means that in our flagship range, the iPhone 6 suddenly takes a higher preference over the Samsung Galaxy S6.

On the other hand, in the sub-₹30,000 segment, the Moto X (2nd Gen) scores big due to its return-on-sale value, update cycles etc., and despite the fact that it costs a lot to repair its screen, the phone edges out the OnePlus One.

The most interesting outcome though is perhaps in the ₹10,000-15,000 range. The Xiaomi Mi 4i closes the gap and becomes almost as desirable as the Zenfone 2 despite being a lower performer overall. The even slower Moto G (3rd Gen) also comes closer to the Zenfone 2, thanks to superior service.

In the sub-10k segment, the Lenovo K3 Note, which was already a better performer than the Yu Yureka Plus, becomes a much better choice given its higher resale value, accessory availability and return on sale. On the other hand, the Moto E (4th Gen) comes much closer to the Redmi 2 and Yu Yuphoria because of its superior update cycles, accessory availability and the fact that it's available offline.

TO CONCLUDE...

It is clear that taking stock of all these aspects can change the way we choose a smartphone. Given the fact that smartphones today are deeply personal devices, and ones that should be used wisely, it seems fair that such emphasis be put on the buying decision. The comparison also shows that all these parameters become all the more crucial when you're considering a phone that is priced higher, while you can perhaps afford to make a simpler, uncomplicated decision, based on performance alone, for a sub-₹10,000 smartphone. **1**

ASUS
IN SEARCH OF INCREDIBLE

ASUS ROG GL552
GAMING WITHOUT LIMITS

Powered by Intel® Core™ i7 processor

*T & C Apply

Join us on facebook.com/ASUSIndia • www.asus.com/in • Toll free No. 1800-2090-365

THE CHOICE OF CHAMPIONS

